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Treasury, strongroom

3.14.1.4 Treasury, strongroom

References:

Hebrew אֲרוֹן (’aron) 2KI 12:10, 2KI 12:11, 2CH 24:8, 2CH 24:10, 2CH 24:11, 2CH 24:11

Hebrew בַּיִת, אָסוּף ((beyth) ’asupim) 1CH 26:15, 1CH 26:17

Hebrew בַּיִת, אוֹצָר ((beyth) ’otsar) DEU 28:12, DEU 32:34, JOS 6:19, JOS 6:24, 1KI 7:51, 1KI 15:18, 1KI 15:18, 2KI 12:19, 2KI 14:14, 2KI 16:8, 2KI 18:15, 2KI 20:13, 2KI 20:15, 2KI 24:13, 2KI 24:13, 1CH 9:26, 1CH 26:20, 1CH 26:20, 1CH 26:22, 1CH 26:24, 1CH 26:26, 1CH 27:25, 1CH 27:25, 1CH 28:12, 1CH 28:12, 1CH 29:8, 2CH 5:1, 2CH 8:15, 2CH 12:9, 2CH 12:9, 2CH 16:2, 2CH 25:24, 2CH 32:27, EZR 2:69, NEH 7:69, NEH 7:70, NEH 10:39, PRO 8:21, EZK 28:4, DAN 1:2, HOS 13:15, MAL 3:10

Hebrew בַּיִת, נְכֹאת (beth nkoth) 2KI 20:13, ISA 39:2

Aramaic גְּנַז (gnaz) EZR 7:20

Hebrew גֶּנֶז (genez) EST 3:9, EST 4:7

Hebrew גַּנְזַךְ (ganzak) 1CH 28:11

Greek γαζοφυλάκιον (gazofulakion) MRK 12:41, MRK 12:41, MRK 12:43, LUK 21:1, JHN 8:20, 1MA 3:28, 1MA 14:49, 2MA 3:6, 2MA 3:24, 2MA 3:28, 2MA 3:40, 2MA 4:42, 2MA 5:18, 4MA 4:3, 4MA 4:6, 1ES 5:44, 1ES 8:18, 1ES 8:44

Greek θησαυρός (thēsauros) SIR 1:25, 1MA 3:29

Greek κορβανᾶς (korbanas) MAT 27:6

Greek ταμιεῖον (tamieion) SIR 29:12

Greek θησαυρός (thesaurus) 4MA 4:7

Latin thesaurus 2ES 6:40

Description and usage:

Southwest corner of the temple mount (model) (© Ray Pritz by United Bible Societies)The treasury was a place for storing valuables belonging to a king or other national authorities. The Temple in Jerusalem had its own treasury. There was no standard size or structure of a treasury.

Translation:

The Hebrew word *’aron* in 2KI 12:9; 2KI 12:10 and 2CH 24:8; 2CH 24:10; 2CH 24:11 refers to a large collection box. According to 2KI 12:9, a hole was cut in its “door.” This would refer to one surface of the box, presumably its top. People could bring

their donations (not coins, which were not yet invented) and insert them into the box through the hole. The donations could then be removed by opening or removing the top.

In some passages the Hebrew word *'otsar* refers to treasure (for example, 2KI 24:13; 2CH 12:9), while in other places it indicates the place where treasure was stored, that is, a treasury (for example, 2KI 20:13; 2CH 32:27). The first half of 1KI 15:18 says literally "And Asa took all the remaining silver and gold in the treasuries of the house of the LORD and [he took] the treasures of the king's house." No translation consulted makes the distinction, although some render both words "treasures" (RSV), while others render both words "treasuries" (NJPSV). In fact, in many of the references under *'otsar* it is not easy to determine if the meaning is "treasure" or "treasure storehouse." In only three places is there specific reference in Hebrew to a "treasure house" (NEH 10:39; DAN 1:2; MAL 3:10).

Where a word for "treasury" is not available, it may be rendered with a descriptive phrase, such as "safe place where the king's [or, Temple's] valuables were kept/were guarded." An alternative model for the last half of MAT 27:6 is "It is against our Law to put it with the money that belongs to the Temple since it is blood money."

In the New Testament the Greek word *gazofulakion* also refers to a box in which donations were collected. According to Jewish tradition, there were thirteen such offering boxes in the Temple, and the receptacles that channeled the money down to the boxes were in the form of trumpets or rams' horns. As a result, the sound of coins falling into the boxes was rather conspicuous. In some cultures such a collection box may be unknown, or at best people know the container that is passed around to collect money in church. If possible, the translation should indicate that the offering box was in a fixed place and not something passed around. In LUK 21:1NCV has "Temple money box" and adds this note: "A special box in the Jewish place of worship where people put their gifts to God." PV uses a longer expression, saying "place reserved for them [gifts]."